



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

I have an opinion on that!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you work long hours?
- What is the best way to maintain balance (work, family, friends, interests) in your life?
- Do you feel you have balance in your life?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk or report about actions, events or people.
- I can ask for somebody's opinion.





Let's Explore!

Sally talks to her **editor*** about the next **issue**** of Cambridge Life.

* An "editor" is the person who decides what content (articles, photos, advertisements) will appear in a newspaper or magazine.

** The word "issue" has different meanings: a printed copy of a magazine, or a social problem.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Ms. Ryan: Hello?

Sally: Good afternoon, Ms. a story I'm thinking about for the next issue.

Ms. Ryan: Great, what is it?

Sally: It's about the best way to maintain work-life balance. I thought about comparing different strategies people use to balance professional life with their family responsibilities. I could ask people's opinions. What do you think about that idea?

Ms. Ryan: I think that's a great idea. I wrote something similar a few years ago. I talked about how to keep an active social life when you start working.

Sally: I think this issue is very important for people who work long hours, like in healthcare.

Ms. Ryan: And also in journalism!

Sally: Could I contact you if I have any questions over the weekend?

Ms. Ryan: Yes, absolutely.

Sally: Thanks. What would be the best way to reach you?

Ms. Ryan: You can send me an e-mail. I am always online.

Sally: Thanks, I really appreciate it.



**Let's Practice!**

Sally and her editor talk about Sally's idea for an article.

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

healthcare / strategies / balance / responsibilities /
to balance / professional / work-life hours / issue

Sally wants to write a story that is about _____. She wants to compare different people use _____ life with their family _____. She thinks this _____ is important for people who work long _____, like in _____.

**Let's Practice!**

What was Sally thinking? What did her editor write?

Instructions: Each sentence contains at least one verb in the Present tense. Changing only one verb, change each sentence to the Simple Past tense.

1. Sally thinks about comparing different strategies for work-life balance.
2. She writes something similar.
3. She talks about how to keep a social life.
4. This issue is very important for people.





Extension Activity

Conduct a survey about the best way to maintain work-life balance.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Explain what work-life balance is to 5 people.
- Ask them if they think this is an important issue for them.
- Ask them about the strategies they use to maintain balance in their life.
- Write a list of the strategies you hear.
- Present the list to your classmates.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I explain work-life balance.

☐ ☐

I ask people's opinions on this topic.

☐ ☐

I write a list of strategies.

☐ ☐

I present the list.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **issue** (noun): a printed document that is part of a collection, like a newspaper or a magazine
e.g. There are a couple of stories I'm thinking about for the next issue of Cambridge Life.
- **work-life balance** (noun): placing equal importance on work and other aspects of life, such as family, friends and personal interests
e.g. One story is about work-life balance.
- **strategy** (noun): a method; technique
Example: I will compare different strategies people use to balance professional life with their family responsibilities.
- **story** (noun): text containing factual information or opinion in a newspaper or magazine
Example: There are a couple of stories I'm thinking about for the next issue of Cambridge Life.
- **to maintain** (verb): to continue to have; to keep up
Example: I talked about how to maintain a social life when you start working.
- **the best way** (expression): a method or technique that is superior to other options
e.g. What would be the best way to reach you?
- **journalism** (noun): jobs in the field of communicating information to the public through newspaper, magazines, television, etc.
e.g. People work long hours in journalism.
- **healthcare** (noun): jobs related to the medical field (doctor, nurse, etc.)
e.g. I think this issue is very important for people who work long hours, like in healthcare.





Learning Points

Simple Past Tense (Irregular Verbs)

With **regular** verbs, the rule is easy. The Simple Past tense always ends in **-ed**:

Base Form	Simple Past Tense
finish	finished
stop	stopped
work	worked

But with **irregular** verbs, there is no rule ...

Irregular verbs in the simple past tense don't end in **-ed**. Read the chart below for some examples.

Sometimes the verb changes completely:	sing buy think	sang bought thought
Sometimes there is no change:	cut read bet	cut read bet

Examples:

- *I thought about comparing different strategies people use to balance professional life with their family responsibilities.*
- *I wrote something similar a few years ago.*

Asking for Somebody's Opinion

You can use the following phrases to ask for somebody's opinion:

What do you think about ... ?
 What's your opinion on ... ?
 Can I have your thoughts on ... ?
 What's your take on ... ?

Examples:

- *I could do a survey on ice cream. What do you think about that idea?*

